

## Jess Hoi-Ki Law | 羅海琪

Stevenson 258  
Department of Linguistics  
UC Santa Cruz  
Santa Cruz, CA 95064

EMAIL [jesslaw@ucsc.edu](mailto:jesslaw@ucsc.edu)  
WEB <https://jesslawucsc.github.io/website/>  
G.SCHOLAR [here](#)

### EMPLOYMENT

2019 - Present      Assistant Professor  
University of California, Santa Cruz

### EDUCATION

2013 - 2019      PhD in Linguistics, Rutgers University  
Dissertation: [Constraints on distributivity](#)  
Committee: Simon Charlow (Co-Chair), Veneeta Dayal (Co-Chair),  
Robert Henderson, Ken Safir

2011 - 2013      MPhil. in Linguistics, Chinese University of Hong Kong  
MPhil Thesis: [Parasitic gaps in Mandarin](#)  
Committee: Candice C.-H. Cheung (Chair), Thomas H.-T. Lee,  
Lawrence Y.-L. Cheung, Marcel den Dikken

2007 - 2010      B.A. in Linguistics, Chinese University of Hong Kong

### WORK IN PROGRESS

| Status         | Title                                                                      | Avenue                          | Author(s)                                  |
|----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| In preparation | Monadic and dyadic final particles in Cantonese                            | TBD                             | Jess H.-K. Law<br>Pranav Anand             |
| In preparation | An AI-assisted multimodal approach to final particles in Mandarin          | <i>Journal of Pragmatics</i>    | Jess H.-K. Law<br>Haoze Li                 |
| In preparation | An AI-assisted multimodal approach to negation and focus in English        | <i>Corpus Pragmatics</i>        | Jess H.-K. Law<br>Pranav Anand<br>Haoze Li |
| Submitted      | Experimental evidence for distinct anaphoric potentials of indefinites and | <i>Glossa Psycholinguistics</i> | Jess H.-K. Law<br>Ziling Zhu               |

## JOURNAL PUBLICATIONS

| Year | Title                                                                                                                               | Journal                                                     | Author(s)                                                                 |
|------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2026 | Final particles in Cantonese                                                                                                        | <i>New Perspectives in Chinese Semantics</i> ,<br>Routledge | Jess H.-K. Law                                                            |
| 2026 | An experimental investigation of the role of pragmatics in focus intervention effects in Mandarin                                   | <i>Journal of East Asian Linguistics</i>                    | Jess H.-K. Law<br>Yaqing Cao<br>Haoze Li                                  |
| 2025 | <a href="#">An affectedness approach to Mandarin passives</a>                                                                       | <i>Journal of East Asian Linguistics</i>                    | Jess H.-K. Law<br>Colin Hirschberg                                        |
| 2024 | <a href="#">Force shift: a case study of Cantonese <i>ho2</i> particle clusters</a>                                                 | <i>Natural Language Semantics</i>                           | Jess H.-K. Law<br>Diti Bhadra<br>Haoze Li                                 |
| 2023 | <a href="#">A New Corpus of Lexical Substitution and Word Blend Errors: Probing the Semantic Structure of Lemma Access Failures</a> | <i>Journal of Cognition</i>                                 | JohnAlderete<br>Melissa Baese-Berk<br>Adrian Brasoveanu<br>Jess H.-K. Law |
| 2022 | <a href="#">The mereological structure of distributivity: a case study of binominal <i>each</i></a>                                 | <i>Journal of Semantics</i>                                 | Jess H.-K. Law                                                            |
| 2016 | <a href="#">Alternatives in different dimensions: A case study of focus intervention</a>                                            | <i>Linguistics &amp; Philosophy</i>                         | Haoze Li<br>Jess H.-K. Law                                                |

## PEER-REVIEWED CONFERENCE PROCEEDINGS

| Year | Title                                                                                       | Proceeding                                | Author(s)                        |
|------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| 2024 | <a href="#">Do we need two uniqueness conditions? A reply to Lewis (2022)</a>               | Proceedings of Sinn und Bedeutung 29      | Jess H.-K. Law<br>Haoze Li       |
| 2018 | <a href="#">Questioning speech acts</a>                                                     | Proceedings of Sinn und Bedeutung 22      | Haoze Li<br>Diti Bhadra          |
| 2017 | <a href="#">Experimental evidence for the discourse potential of bare nouns in Mandarin</a> | Proceedings of the 47th Annual Meeting of | Jess H.-K. Law<br>Kristen Syrett |

| Year | Title                                                                      | Proceeding                                                                        | Author(s)                  |
|------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
|      |                                                                            | North East Linguistic Society (NELS 47)                                           |                            |
| 2017 | <a href="#">The number sensitivity of modal indefinites</a>                | Proceedings of Sinn und Bedeutung 21 (SuB 21)                                     | Jess H.-K. Law             |
| 2017 | <a href="#">At least some distributive items aren't distributive items</a> | Proceedings of the 46th Annual Meeting of North East Linguistic Society (NELS 46) | Haoze Li<br>Jess H.-K. Law |

#### PEER-REVIEWED CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

| Year | Title                                                                            | Conference                                                                 | Author(s)                          |
|------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| 2025 | Cantonese particle <i>aa3</i> as a marker of illocutionary distance              | International Pragmatics Conference 19, University of Queensland, Brisbane | Jess H.-K. Law<br>Pranav Anand     |
| 2024 | Do we need two uniqueness conditions?                                            | Sinn und Bedeutung 29                                                      | Jess H.-K. Law<br>Haoze Li         |
| 2023 | Affectedness in passives                                                         | The 13th Workshop on Theoretical East Asian Linguistics                    | Jess H.-K. Law<br>Colin Hirschberg |
| 2022 | Focus intervention effects in Mandarin                                           | The 35th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing (HSP 35)           | Yaqing Cao<br>Jess H.-K. Law       |
| 2019 | Independence in distributivity                                                   | The 29th annual meeting of Semantics and Linguistic Theory (SALT 29)       | Jess H.-K. Law                     |
| 2019 | Experimental support for discourse translucency of bare noun phrases in Mandarin | The 92nd Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America (LSA 92)      | Jess H.-K. Law<br>Kristen Syrett   |

|      |                                                                                          |                                                                          |                                           |
|------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| 2018 | Monotonicity in distributivity with binominal each                                       | The 49th Annual Meeting of North East Linguistic Society                 | Jess H.-K. Law                            |
| 2017 | Questioning Speech Acts                                                                  | Sinn und Bedeutung 22 (SuB 22)                                           | Jess H.-K. Law<br>Diti Bhadra<br>Haoze Li |
| 2016 | Experimental evidence for the discourse potential of bare nouns                          | The 47th annual meeting of North East Linguistic Society (NELS 47)       | Jess H.-K. Law<br>Kristen Syrett          |
| 2016 | The number sensitivity of modal indefinites                                              | Sinn und Bedeutung 21 (SuB 21)                                           | Jess H.-K. Law                            |
| 2015 | At least some distributive operators aren't distributive operators.                      | The 46th annual meeting of North East Linguistic Society (NELS 46)       | Haoze Li<br>Jess H.-K. Law                |
| 2014 | Focus intervention effects and the quantificational domains of focus-sensitive operators | The 37th annual meeting of Generative Linguistics in Old World (GLOW 37) | Haoze Li<br>Jess H.-K. Law                |
| 2013 | Focus intervention effects                                                               | The 44th annual meeting of North East Linguistic Society (NELS 44)       | Haoze Li<br>Jess H.-K. Law                |

#### GRANTS/HONORS/AWARDS

| Year        | Project                                                  | Agency                          | Amount    |
|-------------|----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|-----------|
| 2025 - 2027 | A multimodal approach to discourse particles (PI)        | COR Large Grant                 | USD11,000 |
| 2024 - 2025 | Developing an online course based on Semantics 1 (Co-PI) | Online Course Development Award | USD40,000 |

|             |                                                                                |                                 |          |
|-------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|----------|
| 2021 - 2022 | A trans-Pacific collaborative course on Chinese languages (PI)                 | Global Classroom Award (UCSC)   | USD4,000 |
| 2020 - 2022 | Diagnosing the variation inference of 'each' (PI)                              | COR Faculty Research Grant      | USD2,500 |
| 2020 - 2021 | Designing an asynchronous online course to teach introductory linguistics (PI) | Online Course Development Award | USD4,000 |
| 2019 - 2020 | Speech acts in particle languages (PI)                                         | New Faculty Research Grant      | USD1,145 |

## INVITED TALKS

| Year | Title                                                                                      | Institute/organization                      | Date               |
|------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| 2025 | Cantonese particle <i>aa3</i> as a marker of illocutionary distance                        | National University of Singapore            | August 1, 2025     |
| 2024 | Confirmational questions: bias and degrees of assertability                                | ZAS, Berlin, Germany                        | June 28, 2024      |
| 2024 | The role of context in intervention effects                                                | National University of Singapore            | September 11, 2024 |
| 2024 | Bare nouns in Mandarin as weak definites: Experimental evidence & theoretical implications | Nanyang Technological University, Singapore | August 30, 2024    |
| 2024 | Confirmational questions as a window into dynamic force determination                      | Fudan University, Shanghai, China           | April 18, 2024     |
| 2023 | Two types of force shifts                                                                  | Georgetown University, USA                  | April 25, 2023     |
| 2022 | To perform or not to perform a speech act                                                  | Edinburgh University, UK                    | April 14, 2022     |
| 2021 | Building complex speech acts                                                               | Zhejiang University, China                  | November 25, 2021  |
| 2021 | Building complex speech acts                                                               | University of California, Los Angeles       | November 12, 2021  |

|      |                               |                     |                  |
|------|-------------------------------|---------------------|------------------|
| 2020 | Questioning speech acts       | Stanford University | January 17, 2020 |
| 2019 | Constraints on distributivity | UC Santa Cruz       | January, 2019    |

## TEACHING

| 2025 - 2026 | Course                                                  | Enrollment | Level |
|-------------|---------------------------------------------------------|------------|-------|
| Fall 2025   | Semantics 1 (LING53)                                    | 70         | UG    |
| Winter 2026 | Course release                                          |            |       |
| Spring 2026 | Introduction to Linguistics (LING50)                    | 117        | UG    |
|             | Semantics 3: A multimodal approach to meaning (LING118) | 3          | UG    |
| 2024 - 2025 | Course                                                  | Enrollment | Level |
| Fall 2024   | Semantics A (LING231)                                   | 10         | PG    |
| Winter 2025 | Semantics 2 (LING116)                                   | 26         | UG    |
|             | Senior Research                                         | 10         | UG    |
| Spring 2025 | Course release                                          |            |       |
| 2023 - 2024 | Course                                                  | Enrollment | Level |
| Fall 2023   | Course release                                          |            |       |
| Winter 2024 | Semantics 1 (LING53)                                    | 121        | UG    |
|             | Semantics Seminar (LING239)                             | 2          | PG    |
| Spring 2024 | Pragmatics (LING117)                                    | 12         | UG    |
|             | Senior Research (LING190)                               | 1          | UG    |
| 2022 - 2023 | Course                                                  | Enrollment | Level |
| Fall 2022   | Pragmatics (LING117)                                    | 29         | UG    |

|             |                         |    |    |
|-------------|-------------------------|----|----|
|             | Semantics A (LING231)   | 5  | PG |
|             | Senior Thesis (LING195) | 1  | UG |
|             | Senior Research         | 6  | UG |
| Winter 2023 | Semantics I (LING53)    | 82 | UG |
|             | Senior Thesis (LING195) | 1  | UG |

Spring 2023

Sabbatical leave

|             |                      |    |    |
|-------------|----------------------|----|----|
| Summer 2023 | Semantics I (LING53) | 17 | UG |
|-------------|----------------------|----|----|

| 2021 - 2022 | Course                                   | Enrollment | Level |
|-------------|------------------------------------------|------------|-------|
| Fall 2021   | Structure of Chinese Languages (LING188) | 21         | UG    |
|             | Semantics A (LING231)                    | 10         | PG    |
|             | Senior Research (LING195)                | 6          | UG    |
| Winter 2022 | Semantics 2 (LING116)                    | 45         | UG    |
|             | Senior Research (LING195)                | 7          | UG    |
|             | Tutorial (LING199F)                      | 1          | UG    |
|             | Independent Study (LING297A)             | 2          | PG    |
| Spring 2022 | Senior Thesis (LING195)                  | 1          | UG    |
|             | Independent Study (LING297A)             | 1          | PG    |
| Summer 2022 | Intro to Linguistics (LING50)            | 45         | UG    |

| 2020 - 2021 | Course                       | Enrollment | Level |
|-------------|------------------------------|------------|-------|
| Fall 2020   | Independent Study (LING297A) | 1          | PG    |
| Winter 2021 | Semantics 2 (LING116)        | 52         | UG    |
| Spring      | Semantics B (LING232)        | 4          | PG    |

| 2019 - 2020 | Course                               | Enrollment | Level      |
|-------------|--------------------------------------|------------|------------|
| Fall        | Semantics Seminar (LING239)          | 5          | PG         |
| Winter      | Semantics 2 (LING116)                | 48         | UG         |
| Spring      | Introduction to Linguistics (LING50) | 212        | UG, online |
| Summer      | Science of Language (LING80S)        | 43         | UG         |

## ADVISING

| Student                                                                                               | Type of research | Role    | Year        |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|---------|-------------|
| Alan Yan, Maria Ralph, Amelia Delso                                                                   | Class project    | Adviser | Spring 2026 |
| Raphael Ostrowski, Makua Nibo                                                                         | Research Fellow  | Adviser | Spring 2026 |
| Emily Knick                                                                                           | Qualifying Paper | Member  | 2025 - 2026 |
| Emma Smith                                                                                            | Qualifying Paper | Member  | 2025 - 2026 |
| Jun Tamura                                                                                            | Dissertation     | Member  | 2023 - 2025 |
| <a href="#">Sadira Lewis</a>                                                                          | BA Thesis        | Chair   | 2022 - 2023 |
| Thesis title: <i>Experimental investigation of the -er morphology and the eventive interpretation</i> |                  |         |             |
| <b>Thesis Award: Koret Scholars (2022-23)</b>                                                         |                  |         |             |
| Eli Sharf                                                                                             | Qualifying paper | Member  | 2022 - 2023 |
| Delaney Jackson-Gomez                                                                                 | MA Thesis        | Member  | 2022 - 2023 |
| <a href="#">Colin Hirschberg</a>                                                                      | BA Thesis        | Chair   | 2021 - 2022 |
| Thesis title: <i>Restrictions on Mandarin bei-passives</i>                                            |                  |         |             |
| <b>Thesis Award: Dean's Award (2022-23)</b>                                                           |                  |         |             |
| Taijing Xiao                                                                                          | MA Thesis        | Chair   | 2021 - 2023 |
| Thesis title: <i>Argument reversals in Mandarin</i>                                                   |                  |         |             |
| <a href="#">Yaqing Cao</a>                                                                            | Qualifying Paper | Chair   | 2020 - 2022 |
| Project title: <i>An experimental study of focus intervention effects in Mandarin</i>                 |                  |         |             |
| Poster presented at the 35th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing (HSP 35)                  |                  |         |             |



|                   |                  |        |             |
|-------------------|------------------|--------|-------------|
|                   | Qualifying Paper | Member | 2021 - 2022 |
|                   | Qualifying Exam  | Member | 2022 - 2023 |
| Lisa Hofmann      | Dissertation     | Member | 2020 - 2022 |
| Andrew Hedding    | Qualifying Exam  | Member | 2019 - 2023 |
| Jack Duff         | Qualifying Paper | Member | 2019 - 2020 |
| Anelia Kudin      | Qualifying Paper | Member | 2019 - 2020 |
| Jeremie Beauchamp | Qualifying Paper | Member | 2019 - 2020 |

### DEPARTMENTAL/CAMPUS SERVICES

|             |                                                                                         |             |
|-------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| 2025 - 2026 | Events Committee<br>(Colloquia, annual UG conference, graduate recruitment events, etc) | Co-Chair    |
| 2024 - 2025 | Fusional Linguistics Initiative                                                         | Organizer   |
| 2021 - 2023 | The annual Linguistics Undergraduate Research Conference                                | Coordinator |
| 2021 - 2023 | The program learning outcomes unit                                                      | Coordinator |

### PROFESSIONAL SERVICES

Chair of Program Committee, [41st West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics](#) (2023)

#### Journal reviewer

Glossa

Journal of Semantics

Language and Linguistics

Natural Language Semantics

Linguistics & Philosophy

#### Conference abstract reviewer

The International Conference on Head-Driven Phrase Structure Grammar (HPSG, 2025)

Human Sentence Processing (HSP, 2022)

Experiments in Linguistic Meaning (ELM, 2022)

Semantics and Linguistic Theory (SALT, 2020, 2023)

North East Linguistic Society (NELS, 2020)

Semantics & Pragmatics

Mid-Atlantic Colloquium of Studies in Meaning  
(MACSIM, 2015-2017)

Studies in Chinese Linguistics

## **SKILLS**

### **Natural language skills**

Cantonese (native)

Mandarin (near native)

Hakka (native, heritage)

English (proficient)

Japanese (basic)

Spanish (basic)

### **Professional skills**

R (Statistical Programming)

Python

PCIBex (for linguistic experimentation)

Latex

ELAN (for multimodal analysis)